

The Reign of Children: The Role of Games and Toys in American Public Libraries, 1876–1925

Jennifer Burek Pierce

Informed by the child study and kindergarten movements, late nineteenth-century US librarians responsible for managing children's rooms believed that their services should include resources that promoted tactile and creative learning. Supported by interdisciplinary scrutiny of child development and children's living conditions, these librarians supplied a variety of toys, games, and illustrative matter in order to provide young library users with engaging, informative resources. Matched by creative programming that recognized children's inclination to do and make, as well as read, this trend was quashed as library leaders sought consistency in the resources and services provided throughout the public library.

Librarians' long-standing interest in good books for children is well documented by historians of the profession; less studied but also evident is librarians' use of toys and games to stimulate enjoyment and learning in the library.¹ This aspect of library services for the young is a notable antecedent to the profession's considerable present-day interest in nonbook resources.² It is also compelling as an intersection of library, educational, and mercantile interests in the child, whose needs were represented in the professional discourses and commercial products of the era. Librarians' convictions emerged from serious and sustained conversations with others in child-centered fields. These discussions also reflected awareness of the burgeoning leisure products marketed to young people and their parents. Framing youth services in these more expansive terms, however, distanced children's librarians from the aims of adult services professionals who believed the emergent, playful orientation of services to the young conflicted with the founding vision of the public library as a center for serious reading and self-improvement.

Jennifer Burek Pierce is associate professor in the School of Library and Information Science at the University of Iowa. She contributes to the Youth Matters column in American Libraries magazine and has authored two books, the most recent of which is What Adolescents Ought to Know.

Initial narratives aligning US public libraries with an agenda of improvement overlooked the vitality of the more playful aspect of the history of youth services, emphasizing a professional interest in good books.³ While more recent histories of library services and media created for the young recognize the impulse toward more entertainment-oriented media,⁴ they return to and emphasize librarians' aspiration to, as Leonard Marcus describes it, a "level of honor and respect . . . as a valued repository of literature and knowledge."⁵ Histories of youth services acknowledge that even as librarians gained cultural authority as book selectors, the first children's libraries were not simply repositories of books. Betsy Hearne contended that early children's librarians "crusaded not for the useful but for the playful and ultimately the aesthetic."⁶ Jacalyn Eddy highlighted Anne Carroll Moore's efforts to "place literature in . . . a 'living context'" through storytelling and décor.⁷ Melanie Kimball also examined these tensions in the development of children's services in St. Louis, where librarians' desire to create a "homelike atmosphere" contended with their strategies for ensuring patrons read "good" books.⁸ Scott Nicholson described later collections that diverged from professional norms.⁹ The intense efforts of children's librarians to provide materials and services grounded in the perceived needs of the young user, however, are best revealed by direct examination of late nineteenth- and early twentieth-century nonbook resources and contemporary discussions of their use in libraries throughout the nation.

Games, toys, and other media, as much as books, figured strongly in libraries throughout the United States. Ohio librarian May Lowe celebrated the start of what she regarded as a trend that would come to define youth services. "In 1892 the reign of the children began, and is constantly increasing and improving," Lowe enthused to readers of *Public Libraries*.¹⁰ "The reign of the children" was marked by colorful pictures, puzzles called dissected maps and sliced animals, and scrapbook-making supplies as essentials of a modern, active children's room. In her enthusiasm for these elements of service, Lowe embraced the ideas of educational psychologists and educators who argued that pictorial media improved children's interest in and comprehension of the world around them. The nascent child study movement, which intended to better young people by understanding their needs, bolstered Lowe's faith that expansive, multimedia children's services would attract young library users. "Once started, I know it will be a success," she told fellow practitioners.¹¹

Here Lowe envisioned youthful enthusiasm for pictures and playthings transferred to enthusiasm for books, and she was far from alone in her belief that library spaces for young people should be engaging. A seminal work of youth services readers' advisory, Caroline Hewins's

1882 *Books for the Young*, begins by touting the importance of toys in children's reading rooms. Her influence could be seen in the claims of librarians around the country that creative displays encouraged children to become individuals interested in books.¹² Arthur E. Bostwick would insist that the modern library was a place where children should be shown "how they might derive pleasure and profit from it," where picture books and "illustrated bulletins" were core elements.¹³ "Pictures and objects may both stimulate the interest of children in certain subjects and direct their attention in desired directions," he wrote, a pronouncement that echoed the premises of early childhood educators of the era.¹⁴ Nonbook resources and the professional dialogue surrounding them also move us toward answers to questions posed by Christine A. Jenkins about relationships between libraries and the original kindergarten movement, with its emphasis on tactile and visual learning.¹⁵

Our perspective on the history of children's librarianship is enhanced by recent interdisciplinary scholarship on the history of childhood. *Huck's Raft*, for example, dismisses the idea that the idyllic, innocent childhood presumed to have unfolded in some golden past ever really existed, while Karen Sánchez-Eppler argues that children were central to reform movements in American history and that this role is reflected in print and visual culture.¹⁶ In these arguments, Mintz and Sánchez-Eppler underscore the agency of children in earlier eras. Librarians who sought to diversify their collections and services indicated in the professional literature that children favored these choices, but fuller accounts of children's responses to these aspects of the children's room have not endured. What stands as evidence of the agency described by Mintz and Sánchez-Eppler is children's librarians' willingness to deviate from the norms articulated by their more senior colleagues in the field to provide nonbook resources to young people. Examined in this context, the materials that young people encountered in libraries courtesy of Lowe and her colleagues reveal a distinctive mode of professional practice that diverged, sharply at times, from the "early attempts on the part of well-meaning men and women to provide children with books" whose work has long inflected histories of US libraries.¹⁷

The emergence of the children's room reversed earlier public library policies barring young people. Nonetheless, reservations about children as library users continued to affect decisions about the resources and services provided to them, and the merits of encouraging youthful imagination and building their skills through nonbook media would not go uncontested. Many commentaries from the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries only cautiously endorsed new means of promoting books and reading to children. Cost commonly generated reservations,

as did suspicion of unchecked enthusiasm for new, unproven modes of service, which one librarian compared to the passion of a “friend who has the automobile fever and forgets that life can hold anything else.”¹⁸ The voices that condemned the experimental nature of youth services then still resonate in questions about new materials for young people in libraries.

Representing the History of Youth Services: Literature and Labels for Younger Library Users

The twenty-first century has seen a surge of advocacy for the use of games in public libraries.¹⁹ Games, particularly apps and interactive computer media, are thought to have considerable draw for younger users. Those interested in this sort of programming tend to tout it as a departure from a long history of book-oriented services to younger library users, as though the use of games were a novelty.²⁰ While scholarly literature on the history of youth services has begun to revise depictions of the typical librarian of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries as the “protector of public morals in print,” as Jenkins phrased it, historical materials ground a richer examination of how librarians who shaped youth services saw their young patrons.²¹

To understand this past, it is necessary to understand how librarians talked about young people.²² The newness of the field meant that much terminology was not standardized, and language describing the younger library user was particularly varied, in part because it encompassed so many ages. Professionals described their encounters with “very young children, many of whom cannot read,” as well as with older youth, who would be called young adults in today’s libraries.²³ For librarians, reformers, and society in general, the word *children* included all youthful patrons, from the little girl too young to sign her name on a library card to the fourteen-year-old boy with the skill to re-create the art displayed on library bulletin boards.²⁴ In children’s reading rooms or, when that much designated space was not possible, little nooks with bright pictures and specially selected books, librarians encountered young people whose education had barely begun, was yet in progress, or had even concluded. In commentary on the value of reading published in 1896, a school principal noted that the vast majority of pupils left school at fourteen.²⁵ Others might have regarded his assessment as optimistic, claiming that 32 percent of students left school before sixth grade, and only 8 percent finished all four years of high school.²⁶ A multimedia children’s room, where pictures and games were as acceptable as books, offered resources intended to be accessible by those with limited literacy skills.

Professionals were aware that one label and one type of service did not suit all comers. One librarian acknowledged that “cunning little chairs and tables” were likely to “[drive] the big boys away in disgust.”²⁷ Another discussed the problems inherent in trying to attract “little ones from all walks of life,” noting, “In an ideal children’s room fathers, mothers, teachers, and older brothers and sisters should be welcome; for if not here, where else shall a little child lead them?”²⁸ Regardless of a seemingly homogenized vocabulary, librarians recognized that young patrons presented a range of needs.

This is not to say that sympathetic comments on young library users and their guardians meant librarians welcomed all youthful activity. While there was a sincere interest in meeting youth on their own terms, library literature from the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries also reflects a desire to curtail youthful exuberance. Some librarians observed, pragmatically and without ire, young patrons’ occasional breaches of decorum, and they addressed these deficits with clubs like one formed in Ottumwa, Iowa, which took as its motto, “Clean Hearts, Clean Hands, and Clean Books.”²⁹ Some were more adamant about the problems posed by active, noisy children who tested the boundaries of good behavior. An 1885 article titled “Suppression of Boys” was a how-to treatise.³⁰ It likely would have been appreciated by the anonymous author of the satiric poem “Nerves (Children’s Room, 4 p.m.),” whose poet lamented the

Horrid, horrid meetings of the pompous A.L.A.
Which show the tired assistant how to tread the shining way,
When all that she desires is to rest her weary soul,
And build a stately altar to the god of birth control.³¹

Such venting aside, the professional literature was not without sympathy for and earnest efforts to understand young people.

H. G. T. Cannons’s *Bibliography of Library Economy* noted the 1892 release of Caroline Hewins’s “Reading for the Young” report and documented the rise of the child study movement, a loosely affiliated group of individuals who aspired to improve conditions for children.³² Adolescent psychologist G. Stanley Hall proclaimed that “children live in an essentially different world than adults,” a message congruent with educator Friedrich Froebel’s claim that education during early, formative years was critical to children’s later development.³³ Hall was a popular speaker, and Froebel’s works were translated and adapted, making their ideas available to library professionals.³⁴ Regardless of present-day concerns about the political motives or guiding philosophy of these

figures and the movements they inspired, contemporary librarians saw their ideals as the basis for a new culture that responded to youthful needs within public libraries.

The connections between developmental treatises and librarians' actions on behalf of young patrons were evident in calls for librarians to share other professionals' concerns with actual children. Much as recent histories of nineteenth-century American childhood establish that race, class, gender, and geography played strong parts in the lived experience of childhood,³⁵ early professionals heard calls for individualized attention to youthful library users. One librarian argued that "when the principle is more fully recognized, to quote from a well-known worker with children, 'that it is of prime importance to study the needs and capabilities of the individual child, rather than the child in the mass,' the work will doubtless be conducted on a larger scale and one more adequate to its importance."³⁶ Her awareness of others' directives advanced the importance of library services to youth by connecting the fledgling area of library work to professions with more status and public visibility, and her words indicated that a collective term for younger users neither belittled them nor failed to differentiate among their many and varied needs. Other librarians echoed her concerns, wondering whether those who insisted library service simply meant providing good books truly understood children, "not the child with a capital C, a laboratory specimen, but living children, with hearts and souls." "Do we understand their interests, and are we sanely sympathetic?" one asked.³⁷ Historian Steven Mintz contends that "childhood has never been insulated from the pressures and demands of the surrounding society, and each generation of children has had to wrestle with the social, political, and economic constraints of its own historical period."³⁸ In their discussions of emerging service imperatives informed by others' work with children, these librarians signaled some awareness of the challenges that children faced in their daily lives.

Beyond the Book: Late Nineteenth- and Early Twentieth-Century Library Materials for Children

While librarians knew their patrons' needs were not necessarily uniform, they nonetheless responded to presumed commonalities. The shared experience of the library in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries involved the availability of toys known as dissected maps and sliced animals and supplies for making scrapbooks as essentials for an active children's room.³⁹ Pictures, preferably colorful ones, and new technologies like lantern slides and stereoscopes were crucial to

attracting young people to the library. When the *Atlantic Monthly* published an article titled "What Public Libraries Are Doing for Children" in 1902, these strategies for luring young people to the library earned the children's assistant the description as "the friend and counselor of all in many ways."⁴⁰ This and other contemporary publications reflect a clear, if small, stream of youth services work involving games and play as American librarianship developed as a profession.

In their focus on visual media for young people, librarians engaged educational philosophies in vogue at the turn of the century, as well as a vast commercial culture that produced a burgeoning number of playthings.⁴¹ Educators hoped their offerings would be as compelling as any entertainment. In texts that saw wide circulation, late nineteenth- and early twentieth-century experts on children's education insisted the child was a curious, capable being best taught by a strategic progression through stages of knowledge. Learning was likened to nourishment, and those responsible for children's development were encouraged "to set before the children tempting banquets on which the hungry little soul may be drawn irresistibly to feed. . . . We are to provide the tools, the child is itself to be judge with how much vigor to use them."⁴² This idealism, in turn, was adopted and adapted as a means of marketing books, toys, and games.

Many little-known librarians endorsed the tenets of the child study movement, chiefly through nonbook materials in the nineteenth-century children's room. These resources were integral to the aims of Froebel-inspired educators, who described the supplies suited to young students' intellectual development as simply "TOYS and GAMES."⁴³ To librarians who were trained as kindergarten teachers or who read about the kindergarten movement, pictures and color were also crucial to aiding young people in acquiring the kind of knowledge that had been declared a public library's proper province.⁴⁴ Librarians' use of puzzles, card games, and images for programming and décor are all documented activities in the early children's rooms in American public libraries, and analysis of the sorts of materials librarians brought to their youthful patrons contributes to our understanding of what happened in early children's rooms in American libraries as librarians balanced their perceptions of young library users' needs, an increasing array of Froebel-inspired products, and the limitations of library budgets.

Among the amusements in children's rooms, the dissected map was prominent. This type of puzzle, which required players to master multiple sorts of information to complete a picture, was an enduring plaything rather than a novelty. Copyright dates on extant puzzles and games of the era indicate that it was not uncommon for these works

to be reissued several decades after the initial publication, perpetuating earlier cultural norms. Its history can be traced to the eighteenth century, and it has been described as the result of “the newly fashionable theories of education, the growing identity of the child as consumer, [and] the importance of geography and mapping in an England aggressively pursuing international trade and conquest.”⁴⁵ Further, scholars have examined maps’ subsequent role in inculcating a sense of nationalism.⁴⁶ At the same time that the dissected map looked back to eighteenth-century ideas about commerce and imperialism, it also aligned with late nineteenth-century education reform. Assembling a dissected map, which meant handling wooden or cardboard forms, understanding principles of mapping, recognizing relationships between rivers and tributaries, and remembering the names of places and their proximity to one another, seemed designed to defeat the disconnected sense that Froebel remembered from his own youthful introduction to the subject.⁴⁷ Librarians who included this type of puzzle in their amusements for children, including Lutie Stearns, promoted myriad values to young people in addition to relatively straightforward facts about place and cartography, not least because dissected maps varied in intricacy of illustration and overall complexity.

Articles in *Public Libraries*, *Library Journal*, and the *ALA Bulletin* do not recommend specific dissected maps for children’s rooms, and several companies produced these materials during the nineteenth century, which means that historians must infer the ones that librarians purchased.⁴⁸ Among the most popular and successful producers was McLoughlin Brothers, a publisher known for vibrant illustrations with wholesome, appealing images of middle-class life, like romping pets and little girls in crisp pinafores playing in clean, well-lighted homes. Patriotic themes; red, white, and blue lettering; and military culture also prevailed in McLoughlin materials for the young.⁴⁹ McLoughlin’s publication of translated European folktales associated with the development of the kindergarten movement further links the products of its press and the ideals of the kindergarten movement and associated contemporary instructional theory.

Dissected maps for children reflected the values and ideas that scholars like John Short have long attributed to mapping. Jill Shefrin has argued that in the late eighteenth century, children’s map-based games shifted their orientation from geography to morality, and specimens such as *Walker’s Geographical Pastime*, first printed in 1812, and the 1822 *Travellers Tour Through the United States*, in which players took a simulated journey, invited their players to make moral judgments.⁵⁰ Voyagers certainly learned facts, from the matter-of-fact, such as which countries



Figure 1. McLoughlin Bros. books and games featured colorful images produced by chromolithography (American Antiquarian Society).

aligned on each half of the globe, to the weather conditions that factored into a long-standing national identity, like Ireland's reputation as the "Emerald Isle" and its principal exports.⁵¹ The games also presented more esoteric information, like the "curious fact" that toads do not live in Ireland and the lengths and widths of both the Sahara Desert and African women's clothing. The didactic directions for *Walker's Geographical Pastime*, which awarded points to players for rescuing Christian slaves in Algiers, and the *Travellers Tour*, which featured venues like the "very

respectable and flourishing seminary” at Dartmouth College, plainly favored particular religious institutions and norms of Western culture.⁵² Still, map-based games sometimes had fanciful elements, depicting sea monsters, exotic birds, and horoscopes.⁵³ The ideas that librarians incorporated into their collections when they put such games on the tables of the children’s room, though, were secondary to the importance of learning by doing.

Late nineteenth-century games that encouraged American children to learn national geography or a state’s features were common.⁵⁴ Makers sometimes assumed a willingness to absorb intricate details about the place one called home. An 1881 map of Wisconsin, for example, required the use of latitude and longitude lines, geographic features like the flow of rivers, and the relative orientation of counties and cities in order to complete the puzzle.⁵⁵ A two-sided McLoughlin puzzle, *A New Dissected Map of the World with a Picture Puzzle of the Capitol at Washington* (1888), depicted the globe and the US Capitol on the same scale, while card games like *Cards of Boston* (n.d.) and *History of Philadelphia* (1872) also imparted patriotic notions about geographic and historical facts.⁵⁶ Most often, scholars call attention to the ideological messages in these materials, but one has quoted an 1807 letter to suggest a further value these games possessed: “No toy is more permanently in requisition than dissected maps and pictures: they are favorites because they require ingenuity and address in putting together & because they fill up a considerable portion of time.”⁵⁷ In the fray of a busy children’s room, these attributes would have had considerable merit.

Mentions of “sliced animals” also occurred in the literature on establishing children’s services.⁵⁸ Unlike dissected maps, *Sliced Animals* was a recent, popular, brand-name product of the E. G. Selchow Company.⁵⁹ Other products in this line included *Sliced Objects*, *Sliced Nations*, and *Sliced Birds*, and an 1879 advertisement in *American Agriculturist* claimed all were “very popular with children.”⁶⁰ The games, which required children to assemble segments of letters and images into a whole word and its representative illustration, obviously aided mastery of spelling; however, the pictures accompanying the letters were more than mere clues to the word to be assembled from strips of colored cardboard. While images guided the formation of words, some images, like a carriage featured in *Sliced Objects* (ca. 1870), extended into a second, letterless panel; the visual elements of the Selchow games were thus significant, following Froebelian precepts.⁶¹ This emphasis, as well as their literacy underpinnings, made them a natural in children’s rooms when librarians believed that “the love of pictures of any kind is an assured trait in children, and children’s libraries can be reinforced by collections of



Figure 2. One of the popular E. G. Selchow games (American Antiquarian Society).

pictures.”⁶² Ads and catalog copy depicted a McLoughlin game readily recognizable as similar to the ones sold by Selchow, and it is impossible to know which company’s products librarians purchased.⁶³

Scrapbooks were also a popular pastime for children, particularly for those not yet able to read, whom many children’s librarians nonetheless welcomed. The activity, with both commercial and home-spun manifestations, had become a normal part of childhood, as the picture for the letter *S* in a McLoughlin abecedarius shows. This image and other discussions of the children’s scrapbook indicated that it was regarded as calming and absorbing, suited to the “convalescent child” and, no less, to the potentially noisy children’s room at the library.⁶⁴ Children’s scrapbooks emulated a popular adult pastime expected to cultivate taste, concentration, and reasoning. By the late nineteenth century, scrapbooks represented a serious adult avocation, and those interested in them were warned against diletantism: “The making of a scrap-book, however, is an art, and it does not come by nature like those simpler accomplishments, reading and writing.”⁶⁵ Like other paper-based games of the

period, the aim was “rational entertainment.”⁶⁶ Librarians who brought scrapbooks into the children’s room, then, were not simply distracting children with a superficial amusement.

There were preprinted scrapbooks for children, including a Mark Twain patented volume with preapplied glue that was dampened before use, and anthologies designed, as one 1840 title explained, for sharing around the family hearth.⁶⁷ Librarians, though, usually collected less costly materials and produced their own volumes of images.⁶⁸ An experienced librarian explained the practice:

[Scrapbooks] consist of newspaper clippings correctly classified, mounted, and bound temporarily with brads.

Among the scrapbooks found especially useful are the ones for Christmas, Thanksgiving, Arbor day, Flag day. Perhaps to the uninitiated this looks very impractical, but it has proved itself to be just the reverse; only the looking over and marking of the newspapers, periodicals, etc., being done by the regular corps of assistants, the cutting and mounting by unremunerative labor. Some will no doubt be surprised that a library should aim to supply help of so definite and comprehensive a nature, but the aim is to be of direct use to the community.⁶⁹

Young patrons made scrapbooks in libraries, too, and children’s enthusiasm for these interactive texts led one librarian to comment that “picture scrapbooks which are made by the children for the children are much enjoyed, both in process of construction and when completed.”⁷⁰ It is evident, then, that long before the late twentieth-century promotion of teen-produced zines and twenty-first-century maker-spaces, librarians facilitated children’s creative expression.

They did so because recent educational theories, particularly those attributed to the kindergarten movement, emphasized the role of the senses in learning. Froebel, whose object lessons asked children to reason about items that they could hold in their hands, found his ideas and his teaching tools adapted for all sorts of enterprises. In addition to straightforward translations, there were card games like Milton Bradley’s Little Object Teacher and its Kindergarten Cabinet full of educational toys.⁷¹ Companies purveying materials that would support these ends made available everything from books produced by the chief proponent of kindergarten to objects intended to convey his lessons.

One contemporary journal explained the philosophy behind the innovative products designed for young people: “We remember not words, but objects. We recall not descriptions, but the images derived

from descriptions. No man, be he ever so eloquent, can give to pupils, in words, so good an idea of the Aphrodite of Melos as a fifteen-cent photograph."⁷² Librarians wanted to ensure children enjoyed whatever advantages images and technology might provide. The impact of images, as well as cost effectiveness, was a sustained theme in the library literature. After cautioning librarians against time-consuming, hand-crafted illustrations when cheap prints were available, Bostwick suggested that a collection of prints, gathered from "all possible sources" that could be loaned to teachers to augment their lessons, was an essential component of youth services work.⁷³ Picture bulletins, as library displays of images were known, saw serious, sustained discussion. A survey of best practices included descriptions of a visual card catalog for children, in which an author's picture and library call numbers were affixed to portable boards; displays of the winners of children's art contests; and an elaborate display of 150 photographs and transparencies, to which librarians added pictures of each bird as it returned in the spring.⁷⁴ The draw of such efforts was recounted in conjunction with a display on technological change; the then-and-now exhibit, which incorporated images of "post-office methods, transportation of all kinds, . . . guns, life-saving methods, [and] diving," was met with enthusiasm. "The children swarmed around the boards every day for the two months it was up," a librarian noted, adding that "one of the pages who was interested in numbers . . . counted 60 [viewers] an hour."⁷⁵ Figures and anecdotes like these testified to the importance and the effects that turn-of-the-century librarians attributed to visual representations of ideas and information.

If a picture was good, however, a stereopticon or an optical lantern—two technologies that afforded more vivid representations—was better. Contemporary discussions of lectures for the young, accompanied by projected images, concurred that concentrating young people's attention upon a single object was an ideal not achieved by a plethora of pictures on a library wall. One sales catalog advertised its wares with such concerns in mind, claiming that "Bands of Hope, Juvenile Humane Societies, etc., which are designed for the benefit of children need every resource for imparting amusement and instruction, judiciously intermingled to keep up the interest of their members. In the Stereopticon they possess the very elements needed for this purpose."⁷⁶ The illuminated viewing device was proposed for home use, with a proprietor noting, "The young people can receive valuable help in forming a refined taste for art by the exercise of care on the part of the older members of the family, in the selection of slides."⁷⁷ Librarians used these technologies, too.⁷⁸ The novelty of glowing, colorful images of museum artifacts, faraway landscapes, or glimpses of the skeleton beneath the



Figures 3 and 4. Magic lantern and lantern slide (Winterthur Museum, Library, and Gardens).

skin was profound, and it was one that publishers aspired to emulate, as when McLoughlin Brothers released *The Aquarium* as part of its Little Showman's Series. The book, which folds open to reveal a diorama, contains a rhyme calling attention to the way its "bright and lovely colors glow."⁷⁹ Despite such textual promises, librarians' convictions in the worth of illuminated images are suggested by the risk inherent in operating these devices, which, at least initially, were not electric, relying on flames for light.⁸⁰ Perhaps librarians anticipated that children's rapt attention to the colorful spectacle would ensure the decorum needed for the safe operation of this early audiovisual equipment.

Realia also augmented images, and the library literature contains numerous descriptions of such exhibitions and children's responsiveness. For example, Bostwick, ever concerned about the appearance of amateurism in such efforts, noted how a collection of Arctic exploration realia loaned to the New York Public Library by the Museum of Natural History was able "to arouse the greatest interest in the Arctic regions among the children in the neighborhood," an educational outcome that "could have been achieved in no other way."⁸¹ Publishers came to echo professionals' intentions of encouraging curiosity and knowledge about the world in which children matured by directing their attention to the things encountered there. *The Object Teacher* (1884) aspired to be seen as "a book of New Ideas for Children."⁸² The title, which borrowed the language of Froebel's educational program, contained images of "familiar objects of special interest." Promotional copy promised that "it will interest them as a Puzzle" and "suggest to them new thoughts and ideas, evoking the vocabulary of texts used to train kindergarten teachers."⁸³ Even if the book had pages that must be turned instead of actual objects that could be handled, its producers were determined to evoke the aura of other media in promoting it to adult purchasers.

The toys, games, and pictures made the children's room "a welcoming, homelike, familiar place . . . where children, many of whom lived in crowded, dingy tenement buildings, could be surrounded by beautiful objects that would inspire their wonder" had multiple implications.⁸⁴ Through these resources, young people would be engaged in ways regarded as optimal for enhancing their memory and perception of significant phenomena; in other words, the librarians who brought dissected maps and other pictures into the children's room saw themselves as enacting the same sorts of cultural aims as their peers in adult services. They did not, however, envisage a grueling, extracurricular learning session taking place in reading rooms for young people. One library boasted that those who enjoyed dissected animals and scrapbooks at the library were "the happiest children anywhere to be found."⁸⁵ The intent



Figure 5. Game cards from the American Antiquarian Society's collection, representing characters from a game version of Harriet Beecher Stowe's novel, *Uncle Tom's Cabin*.

of appealing to young people through nonbook resources was sincere, as was the belief that a dissected map or a colorful illustration contributed as much to a child's understanding as a book might.

Further, by placing these materials in a library space for younger patrons, librarians altered the dynamic that often governed games. Shefrin indicates that when dissected maps and the related travel games were developed, families played together.⁸⁶ In the special spaces for the young in libraries, it is quite likely that children would have played with other children rather than only with the adults who once guided their games. In this context, May Lowe's declaration that youth services instantiated "the reign of the children" is provocative and striking. The children's library conceptualized by these early professionals was one that fostered peer relationships as much as those between adult and child.

These resources did not displace books, especially since plenty of games alluded to well-known books. Publishers translated classics and contemporary titles into the games that were expected to engage children. The Houghton Library documents two card games based on eighteenth-century novels, and the American Antiquarian Society holds numerous games that depend on knowledge of the works of Dickens, Shakespeare, and Harriet Beecher Stowe, authors whose works

were included on recommended lists of titles for younger readers.⁸⁷ Winterthur's collections of children's books feature more such works, as well as short stories written by authors of English-language kindergarten instruction manuals.⁸⁸ Thus, intermediation, or the existence of relationships across media with common origins and themes, was part of the print culture of these earlier eras.⁸⁹ E. Richard McKinstry has determined that it was a practice that publisher Charles Magnus began before the late nineteenth century: "Hoping to appeal to a literary public, sometime during the early 1860s Magnus issued a series of jigsaw puzzles entitled 'New Object of Delight: Dissected Story Pictures for the Young.'" ⁹⁰ Magnus's puzzles were simple versions of stories, including *Robinson Crusoe* and *Don Quixote*.⁹¹ Still others produced stories illustrated by paper dolls.⁹² Numerous books contained instructions for making toys; some, like *The Star Toy Maker*, were compiled from young people's submissions.⁹³ Connections between literary texts and games and toys, however much they enriched the print culture of the children's room, proved insufficient to counter a rising opposition to innovative services and sources.

Conclusion: "The Experimental Temptation" Is Banished

In the early years of the profession, youth services librarians employed varied and often colorful means of engaging young people's interests and welcoming them into the library. The span of such activities was revealed by one 1902 article that described not only story times and books but military drill exercises for boys' clubs, decoration of the reading room with fresh flowers picked by groups of girls, a printing press, and a dark room and by a slightly later article advocating an outdoor wildflower walk and talk program.⁹⁴ Anne Carroll Moore had also provided similar resources to youthful patrons in New York.⁹⁵ The belief that libraries ought to both teach and delight their young patrons by going beyond the book was increasingly central to youth services in this era, but this approach was not shared by all. Librarian Elizabeth Porter Clarke acknowledged, "Whether games and amusements pure and simple do not belong more properly to the Y.M.C.A. and how far they should be introduced into a public library is a question."⁹⁶ Where Clarke was tentative, others firmly opposed what one called "the experimental temptation."⁹⁷

This temptation was most strongly associated with children's services and seen as something other than true librarianship. Librarian Montrose J. Moses, who cited Matthew Arnold on culture and defined the role of the library as "a literary academy," intoned, "The library journals will

indicate how recently children's work in the library has become differentiated from the rest of the work; in fact, there is a danger at the present time, that too wide a gap is being created in the minds of some between the Children's Room *per se* and the library problem as a whole."⁹⁸ The issue had been raised before. As early as 1901, one librarian complained that children's services were developing in a disunified, disorderly way, counter to the impulses of efficiency and uniformity urged by figures such as Melvil Dewey. While any number of her peers in youth services enjoyed the freedom to experiment with activities with potential child appeal, Clara Whitehill Hunt decried the lack of organizational guidance on shaping children's services, arguing that professional organizations and senior administrators within particular institutions should shape directions for service, not specialized children's librarians: "If the senior members of the American Library Association, the librarians-in-chief, would consider the children's room of enough importance to give us their ideas of what it should stand for, what its scope should be, the result might be more uniformity of thought among members of the library profession . . . and a more sensible attitude toward the children's room in the library."⁹⁹ In the absence of managerial input, the librarian-author seemed to prefer conformist, rather than innovative, services. "The children's room is only one room in a great dignified library," she wrote. "All its management and spirit should correspond as closely as possible to that of the other departments."¹⁰⁰ It was a call for decisions about children's needs and interests to be made by people whose central concerns lay outside of youth services, who had not necessarily endeavored to understand what others knew about childhood. Her views would eventually resonate within the profession.

Those who concurred attacked the chief emblem of the children's room, its brightly colored picture bulletin board, as something that distracted young readers from proper attention to books.¹⁰¹ The colorful images, inspired by recent educational theories and influenced, too, by the proliferating commercial products for young consumers, were found wanting in taste. Bostwick, though he championed services to children, was cautious in his recommendations about pictures, noting a wave of complaints about the time bulletin boards consumed and "illegible" book recommendations that sometimes accompanied the art.¹⁰² He was not the only one to challenge children's librarians' strategies. "Unfortunately all good librarians are not always good art critics, and in some libraries, especially children's rooms, the dignity and beauty of the surroundings are spoiled by atrocities of pictures, colored and otherwise, which have been collected and arranged . . . with [the] most . . . inartistic effect," *Library Journal's* readers were advised in 1902. The remedy,

though, was simple: "Eliminate . . . everything which in the slightest degree makes one, child or adult, forget that it is . . . a place to gain knowledge and to add culture."¹⁰³ This mandate would obligate children's librarians to connect with their peers, not their youthful patrons.

Eventually, this more critical, even dismissive, perspective prevailed. A 1906 survey of children's services in the one hundred largest US cities focused on general aspects of operating a children's room, asking questions about supervision and staffing, cooperation with entities outside the library, the selection of books, the ages at which children were fined for overdue materials, and matters such as enforcing discipline.¹⁰⁴ This assessment of practice examined a narrowed scope of work undertaken by children's librarians, whose duties were here conceived of as managing collections of books and facilities. Efforts to reveal the breadth or the distinctiveness of library services to young people were not evaluated. One librarian chafed at these limitations. Her insistence that "it is difficult to define the 'scope'—anything of interest to young people in the library may come into this department" was noted.¹⁰⁵ A handful of other librarians also added what the survey did not invite them to share, reporting on their circulating picture collections and "giving of lectures with lantern slides, travel talks, etc., the use of stereoscopes mounted on a table with pictures constantly on exhibition."¹⁰⁶ While lingering strains of child-oriented work were evident, so were top-down efforts to define professionalism in terms that aligned the responsibilities of children's librarians with their colleagues in adult services.

Later professionals who promoted nonbook activities stressed the educational and improving aspects of these activities for children. These programs were more library specific, less divergent in their origins. In 1915 a game intended to teach card catalog skills to older children was promoted, with its librarian-author acknowledging that she had seen the game played elsewhere. The game's purpose was unequivocally instructional, hoping to acquaint children with the workings of the card catalog and "books of value but little known."¹⁰⁷ In 1924 an article whose title seemingly echoed librarians' earlier interests in creative means of bringing about youthful library use—"What Do Public Libraries Contribute to the Development of Children by the Work of the Children's Department?"—focused on Americanization of immigrants and young people's library-fostered self-improvement, ends achieved through "universally used and approved" methods.¹⁰⁸ Another librarian showed weekly movies and collected data from her young patrons to demonstrate that the greatest preference was for *The Birth of a Nation*.¹⁰⁹ The idea that what appealed to the youngest minds might somehow detract from the purpose of the program was evident in the librarian's

admission that only children in fourth grade or above were allowed to vote, because “it was felt that the answers of the very young children might not be accurate and our aim was to have the statistics as reliable as possible.”¹¹⁰ By the close of the Progressive Era, the self-perceived need of the profession to present sound evidence of improving, book-centered activities had begun to hush the voices of the youngest participants. The vibrant culture of the children’s room that May Lowe anticipated in the nineteenth century had dimmed considerably.

Despite the shift in emphasis brought about by efforts to bring children’s services in line with the conventions of adult services, games and toys were once a standard part of children’s services in American libraries. While twenty-first-century librarians often justify the creative services and resources they provide to young people by evoking the idea that what they are doing is new and untried, their predecessors made earnest efforts to engage young people with games and nonbook media when serving young people was itself new and little regulated by library managers. Pressure from librarians who did not specialize in youth services was a significant force in the demise of early interactive and game-oriented programming, which was seen as detracting from the overall institutional mission. Educational and improving aspirations, the watchwords of the Carnegie-funded library, prevailed over children’s librarians’ efforts to link recent learning theory and community needs with nonbook resources. In his history of children’s literature, Seth Lerer observed, “For a long time, what was *not* literature was the ephemeral, the popular, the feminine, the childish.”¹¹¹ Even within libraries, such traits were once dismissed as undesirable.

As twenty-first-century librarians emphasize new media and spaces suited to child and adolescent preferences, they need to know that the terrain they survey is one the profession has visited before. Present-day librarians interested in apps, computer games, and other types of atypical materials are better positioned than their predecessors to win arguments about the worth of the services they seek to provide. Adult services librarians, too, have closed the gap by endeavoring to make games and downloadable content available to library users of all ages. Yet there are hints that children’s librarians still exercise a watchful self-restriction, found, for example, in cautions that e-books might entertain rather than encourage attention to narrative and other traditional literary criteria. An article in *School Library Journal* has commented on the moving parts in children’s e-books, asking whether “electronic picture books [are] good for kids, and can they get them hooked on reading by expanding access to engaging titles? Or are digital books one more step down that slippery slope to less and less interaction with print just when

children need it most?"¹¹² Another asks, rhetorically, "If a child can move around chirping birds, does that action serve the story? Even if it doesn't, does it actively distract a child from enjoying the story? Would a kid be inclined to just move around birds all day, entirely forgetting the story being told, or would they be inclined to continue reading or listening to it?"¹¹³ This time, the bright colors, the noisy sounds, and the nontraditional material are contained within digital devices. Whether we have learned to think expansively about the possibilities of children's services, then, is an open question. Even in the twenty-first century, children's librarians must still work to bring about the reign of children in the services to young library users.

Notes

1. Numerous publications document, either directly or indirectly, late nineteenth- and early twentieth-century librarians' inclinations toward improving literature for young people. For discussion, see sources including Jacalyn Eddy, *Bookwomen: Creating an Empire in Children's Book Publishing, 1919–1939* (Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 2006); Christine Jenkins, "The History of Youth Services Librarianship: A Review of the Research Literature," *Libraries and Culture* 35, no. 1 (2000): 126–27; and Jennifer Burek Pierce, "Why Girls Go Wrong: Advising Female Teen Readers in the Early Twentieth Century," *Library Quarterly* 77, no. 3 (2007): 311–26.

2. Megan Cottrell, "Toy Libraries: A Place to Play," *American Libraries* (November/December 2013): 14–15; Scott Nicholson, "Games in Libraries," <http://www.gamesinlibraries.org/>; Eli Neiburger, *Gamers . . . in the Library?! The Why, What, and How of Videogame Tournaments for All Ages* (Chicago: ALA Editions, 2007).

3. Esther Jane Carrier, *Fiction in Public Libraries, 1876–1900* (New York: Scarecrow Press, 1965); Sydney Ditzion, *Arsenals of a Democratic Culture: A Social History of the American Public Library Movement in New England and the Middle Atlantic States from 1850 to 1900* (Chicago: American Library Association, 1947); Dee Garrison, *Apostles of Culture: The Public Librarian and American Society, 1876–1920* (New York: Free Press, 1979).

4. Eddy, *Bookwomen*; Leonard S. Marcus, *Minders of Make-Believe: Idealists, Entrepreneurs, and the Shaping of American Children's Literature* (New York: Houghton Mifflin Company, 2008); Kate McDowell, "Children's Voices in Librarians' Words, 1890–1930," *Libraries & the Cultural Record* 46, no. 1 (2011): 73–101.

5. Marcus, *Minders of Make-Believe*, 217.

6. Betsy Gould Hearne and Christine Jenkins, "Sacred Texts: What Our Foremothers Left Us in the Way of Psalms, Proverbs, Precepts, and Practices," *Horn Book*, September/October 1999, 538.

7. Eddy, *Bookwomen*, 36.

8. Melanie A. Kimball, "'A Home-like Atmosphere': The Advent of Children's Rooms at St. Louis Public Library, 1906–1912," *Library Trends* 62, no. 3 (2014): 497–98.

9. Scott Nicholson, "Playing in the Past: A History of Games, Toys, and Puzzles in North American Libraries," *Library Quarterly* 83, no. 4 (2013): 341–61.

10. May Lowe, "Reading Rooms for Children," *Public Libraries* 2, no. 4 (1897): 127.
11. *Ibid.*, 128.
12. Mary E. S. Root and Adelaide Bowes Maltby, "Picture Bulletins in the Children's Library," in *Library Work with Children*, ed. Alice I. Hazeltine (White Plains, NY: H. W. Wilson Co., 1917), 187–94.
13. Arthur E. Bostwick, *The American Public Library* (New York: D. Appleton and Company, 1910), 76, 79–80.
14. *Ibid.*, 85.
15. Jenkins, "The History of Youth Services Librarianship," 128.
16. Steven Mintz, *Huck's Raft: A History of American Childhood* (Cambridge, MA: Belknap Press, 2004); Karen Sánchez-Eppler, *Dependent States: The Child's Part in Nineteenth-Century American Culture* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2005).
17. Sara Innis Fenwick, "Library Service to Children and Young People," *Library Trends* 25, no. 1 (1976): 329.
18. Alice A. Blanchard, "Story Telling as a Library Tool," in Hazeltine, *Library Work with Children*, 290.
19. Multiple online resources promote the use of games in libraries, such as International Games Day @ Your Library, <http://ilovelibraries.org/gaming/> (accessed March 17, 2015), and ALA's Games and Gaming Resources wiki, http://gaming.ala.org/resources/index.php?title=Games_and_Gaming_Resources (accessed March 17, 2015). The practice is also discussed by Neiburger, *Gamers*; and Brian Mayer and Christopher Harris, *Libraries Got Game: Aligned Learning through Modern Board Games* (Chicago: ALA Editions, 2010).
20. See, for instance, Scott Nicholson, "The Role of Gaming in Libraries: Taking the Pulse" (2007), white paper, <http://scottnicholson.com/pubs/pulse2007.pdf>, for an example of scholarly research using the twenty-first century as a starting point for understanding the use of games in libraries.
21. Christine Jenkins, "'Since So Many of Today's Librarians Are Women . . .': Women and Intellectual Freedom in U.S. Librarianship, 1890–1990," in *Reclaiming the American Library Past: Writing the Women In*, ed. Suzanne Hildenbrand (Norwood, NJ: Ablex Publishing Co., 1996), 223.
22. Compare Bernd Frohmann, "Discourse Analysis as a Research Method in Library and Information Science," *Library and Information Science Research* 16, no. 2 (1994): 135; John M. Budd and Douglas Raber, "Discourse Analysis: Method and Application in the Study of Information," *Information Processing and Management* 32, no. 2 (1996): 217–26.
23. Lowe, "Reading Rooms for Children," 127.
24. See Hazeltine, *Library Work with Children*.
25. Mary E. Comstock, "The Library as an Educational Factor," *Library Journal* 21, no. 4 (1896): 147.
26. Gertrude E. Andrus, "How the Library Is Meeting the Changing Conditions of Child Life," *Bulletin of the American Library Association* 7, no. 4 (1913): 192.
27. Clara Whitehill Hunt, "Opening a Children's Room," in *Papers and Proceedings of the Twenty-Third General Meeting of the American Library Association Held at Waukesha Wisconsin July 4–10, 1901* (Chicago: American Library Association, 1901), 85.
28. Mary Ella Dousman, "Children's Departments," *Library Journal* 21, no. 9 (1896): 406.

29. "Ottumwa Library League to Be Formed by Young People Who Patronize the Library," *Ottumwa Daily Courier*, February 21, 1903, 1.

30. E. C. Arnold, "Suppression of Boys," *Library Journal* 10, no. 5 (1885): 107.

31. "Nerves (Children's Room, 4 p.m.)," *Library Journal* 42, no. 9 (1917): 734.

32. H. G. T. Cannons, *Bibliography of Library Economy* (London: Stanley Russell & Co., 1910), 244, 409. The connection between the child-study movement and early youth services librarianship was discussed by Hiller C. Wellman, "What Public Libraries Are Doing for Children," *Atlantic Monthly* 90 (1902): 402–9. Further, the precise reason Lowe fixed on 1892 is not entirely clear; while this is the first time that Hewins's *Reading* report is cited in Cannons's *Bibliography*, the reports were issued over a series of years; see Kate McDowell, "Surveying the Field: The Research Model of Women in Librarianship, 1882–1898," *Library Quarterly* 79, no. 3 (2009): 279–300, doi: 10.1086/599126.

33. Hall quoted in Caroline Levander, "'Informed Eyes': The 1890s Child Study Movement and Henry James's *Turn of the Screw*," *Critical Matrix* 12, no. 1 (2001): 9. See also "Froebel and the Kindergarten," in *Miscellaneous Pamphlets Bound in One Volume, 3–16* (London: Froebel Society, 1828).

34. See, for example, Heinrich Hoffmann, *Kindergarten Toys, and How to Use Them* (New York: E. Steiger, 1874), held at the Winterthur Library.

35. Sánchez-Eppler, *Dependent States*.

36. Emma Louise Adams, "Children's Library Methods as Determined by the Needs of Children," *Public Libraries* 2, no. 8 (1897): 396.

37. Faith E. Smith, "Changing Conditions of Child Life," *Bulletin of the American Library Association* 7, no. 4 (1913): 188.

38. Mintz, *Huck's Raft*, vii.

39. Scholars of childhood link dissected maps and the development of puzzles in their study of historic children's toys; see Martin Norgate, "Cutting Borders: Dissected Maps and the Origins of the Jigsaw Puzzle," *Cartographic Journal* 44, no. 4 (2007): 342–50; and Jill Shefrin, *Neatly Dissected for the Instruction of Young Ladies and Gentlemen in the Knowledge of Geography: John Spilsbury and Early Dissected Puzzles* (Los Angeles: Cotsen Occasional Press, 1999).

40. Wellman, "What Public Libraries Are Doing," 405.

41. A large sample of paper toys is found at Winterthur in Collection 121, 78x317.14, Waldron Collection.

42. "Froebel and the Kindergarten," 4.

43. *Ibid.*

44. The importance of Froebelian training for children's librarians is discussed in W. C. Berwick Sayers, *The Children's Library: A Practical Manual for Public, School, and Home Libraries* (New York: E. P. Dutton & Co., 1911), 196–98.

45. Shefrin, *Neatly Dissected*, 9–10.

46. John R. Short, *Representing the Republic: Mapping the United States, 1600–1900* (London: Reaktion Books, 2001); Martin Brückner, *The Geographic Revolution in Early America: Maps, Literacy, and National Identity* (Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 2006).

47. Contemporaries attributed the following complaint to the educator: "Geography," he says, 'we learnt parrotwise, with many words and little understanding: it was sufficient if we could name correctly our little patches of color on the map. There was no link, not the very weakest, to couple with the realities of life'" ("Froebel and the Kindergarten," 5).

48. A number of articles simply reference these resources briefly, as in the following passage about the Marshalltown, Iowa, public library from "Problems of Discipline" in *Library Work with Children*: "There are dissected maps, quiet games, and stereopticon views on their tables beside Caldecott's and other picture books and they are so well entertained that there is no occasion for mischief" (Mary Emogene Hazeltine and Harriet Price Sawyer, "Problems of Discipline," in Hazeltine, *Library Work with Children*, 255).

49. *Starry Flag ABC Book* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., 1899); *Young America's ABC and Pretty Picture Book* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., 1900), both from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.

50. Shefrin, *Neatly Dissected*, 20.

51. *Walker's Geographical Pastime* (1812), Instructions to Players, 2, held in the Geography and Map Division, Library of Congress.

52. *Ibid.*, 44; *The Travellers Tour Through the United States* (New York: F. & R. Lockwood, 1822), 20, from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.

53. See, for example, *Game of the Star-Spangled Banner, or Emigrants to the United States* (London: E. Wallis, 1835), and *The World* (n.d.), both from the private collection of Bob Armstrong, Worcester, Massachusetts. Armstrong's puzzle collection has been featured on *History Detectives*, Public Broadcasting System (July 16, 2003).

54. Examples include *Dissected Map of the United States* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., 1900); *American Map Company's Educational Dissected Map of the United States* (Boston: American Map Co., 1900); and *Dissected State Maps: Michigan* (Chesaning, MI: W. L. Ireland, 1903), all held in the Geography and Map Division, Library of Congress.

55. Robert Graham, *Dissected Map of Wisconsin from Official Records* (Madison, WI: Wm. J. Park & Co., 1881), held in the Geography and Map Division, Library of Congress.

56. *A New Dissected Map of the World with a Picture Puzzle of the Capitol at Washington* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., 1888), from the private collection of Bob Armstrong, Worcester, MA; *Cards of Boston: An Amusing and Interactive Game* (n.d.), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH; Eliza Leslie, *History of Philadelphia: A Game for Children* (Philadelphia, 1872), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.

57. Shefrin, *Neatly Dissected*, 22.

58. See, for example, Dousman, "Children's Departments," 407.

59. *Sliced Animals Improved or Spelling Made Easy* (New York: E. G. Selchow & Co., ca. 1875), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.

60. *Sliced Nations* (New York: E. G. Selchow & Co., ca. 1875), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH; "No. 235: Sliced Objects; Sliced Birds; Sliced Animals," *American Agriculturalist* 38 (1879): 433.

61. "Coach," *Sliced Objects* (New York: E. G. Selchow & Co., ca. 1870), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.

62. Sayers, *The Children's Library*, 145.

63. *Childrens'* [sic] *Amusements* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., n.d.).

64. Mary Jackson Lee, "Window Shopping," *House Beautiful*, July 1932, 1, Misc. Papers, Collection 56, Correspondence/Misc. box 10, location 16/D/2, R. T. Haines Halsey Papers, Winterthur Library.

65. Arthur Penn, *The Home Library* (New York: D. Appleton and Company, 1883), 79.
66. *The Flower Game* (n.d.), 73x319.96, Winterthur Library.
67. Penn, *The Home Library*, 81; Sarah Stickney Ellis, *The Juvenile Scrap-Book* (London: Fisher, Son and Co., 1840), held at the Lilly Library, Indiana University, Bloomington.
68. Root and Bowes Maltby, "Picture Bulletins," 193.
69. Eva L. Moore, "Literary Clubs, Reference Work, and Special Lists on Special Subjects and Occasions," *Public Libraries* 2, no. 6 (1897): 292.
70. Lowe, "Reading Rooms," 127.
71. Milton Bradley and Company, *Bradley's Games, Toys, Industrial Amusements and Novelties* (Springfield, MA: Milton Bradley, 1883), 31, 33, held at the Winterthur Library.
72. George R. Swain, "The Stereopticon in Secondary Teaching," *School Review* 10, no. 2 (1902): 146.
73. Bostwick, *The American Public Library*, 99.
74. Root and Bowes Maltby, "Picture Bulletins," 188–89, 192.
75. *Ibid.*, 192.
76. *Illustrated Catalogue of Stereopticons, Sciopicons, Dissolving View Apparatus, Microscopes, Solar Microscope and Stereopticon Combination, Objectives, Photographic Transparencies, Plain and Artistically Colored Views and Microscopical Preparations* (Chicago: McIntosh Battery and Optical Co., 1895), 6.
77. *Ibid.*, 7.
78. Documentation of the increasing normalcy of the practice can be found in Sayers, *The Children's Library*, 149.
79. *The Aquarium: The Little Showman's Series* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., [1886?]), held in the Winterthur Library.
80. Collection 121, 74x438, series VI.A: Toy Theaters, Maxine Waldron Collection, Winterthur Library.
81. Bostwick, *The American Public Library*, 87.
82. *The Object Teacher* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., 1884), from the American Antiquarian Society collection, Hanover, NH.
83. Milton Bradley and Company, *Bradley's Games, Toys, Industrial Amusements and Novelties*, 31.
84. Virginia A. Walter, *Twenty-First-Century Kids, Twenty-First-Century Librarians* (Chicago: ALA Editions, 2010), 3.
85. Dousman, "Children's Departments," 407.
86. Shefrin, *Neatly Dissected*, 21.
87. "What's New: Colorful Adventures," *Houghton Library Blog*, May 10, 2013, <http://blogs.law.harvard.edu/houghton/2013/05/10/whats-new-colorful-adventures/>. And see, for example, *Nick Bottom's Game of Shakespeare* (New York: C. S. Francis & Co., n.d.), and *Game of Uncle Tom and Little Eva* (Providence, RI: V. S. W. Parkhurst, 1852), both from box 1, C & D of Amusements, American Antiquarian Society Games collection.
88. See, for example, Heinrich Hoffmann, *Cruel Boy & the Magpie* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., ca. 1880); Heinrich Hoffmann, *Little Suck-a-Thumb* (New York: McLoughlin Bros., ca. 1880), both held at the Winterthur Library.
89. See Henry Jenkins, *Convergence Culture: Where Old and New Media Collide* (New York: New York University Press, 2006).

90. E. Richard McKinstry, *Charles Magnus, Lithographer: Illustrating America's Past, 1850–1900* (New Castle, DE: Oak Knoll Press, 2013), 94–95.

91. *Ibid.*, 95–96.

92. Edith Flack Ackley, *Paper Dolls: Their History and How to Make Them* (Philadelphia: J. B. Lippincott, 1939), 73.

93. Jack Read, ed., *The Star Toy Maker*, Star Red Book Library, no. 4 (Chicago: W. D. Boyce Co., 1907); T. O'Connor Sloane, *Electric Toy Making for Amateurs* (New York: Munn & Co., 1903); Ebenezer Landells, *Ornamental Toys and How to Make Them* (Boston: Cyrus G. Cooke, n.d.), all held at the Winterthur Library.

94. Elizabeth Porter Clarke, "Story-Telling, Reading Aloud and Other Special Features of Work in Children's Rooms," *Library Journal* 27, no. 4 (1902): 190; Charles S. Greene, "School and Library Wild Flower Day at Oakland (Cal.) Public Library," *Library Journal* 30, no. 6 (1905): 344–45.

95. Eddy, *Bookwomen*, 38.

96. Clarke, "Story-Telling," 190.

97. Montrose J. Moses, "The Experimental Temptation; or The Attractive Power of Books *versus* the Librarian's Method," *Library Journal* 34, no. 6 (1909): 247–53.

98. *Ibid.*, 252, 247.

99. Hunt, "Opening a Children's Room," 85.

100. *Ibid.*, 85–86.

101. Numerous articles testify to the use of bulletin boards in children's rooms; see Sayers, *The Children's Library*, 87, 148; Purd B. Wright, "Some Methods of Library Advertising," in *Papers and Proceedings of the Twenty-Eighth General Meeting of the American Library Association Held at Narragansett Pier, R.I. June 29–July 6, 1906* (Chicago: American Library Association, 1906), 87; and Lowe, "Reading Rooms for Children," 126, 128.

102. Bostwick, *The American Public Library*, 86–87.

103. Ella F. Corwin, "Some Fads and Fallacies in Library Work," *Library Journal* 27, no. 9 (1902): 822.

104. Arabelle Jackson, "Report on Library Work with Children," in *Papers and Proceedings of the Twenty-Eighth General Meeting*, 89–97.

105. *Ibid.*, 89.

106. *Ibid.*, 90.

107. Isabel Du Bois, "A Library Game," *Public Libraries* 20, no. 3 (1915): 119.

108. "What Do Public Libraries Contribute to the Development of Children by the Work of the Children's Department?," *Public Libraries* 29, no. 7 (1924): 369.

109. Marie Pinney, "Boise Children's Librarian Takes Active Hand in Movie Situation," *Library Journal* 44, no. 1 (1919): 47–48.

110. *Ibid.*, 48.

111. Seth Lerer, *Children's Literature: A Reader's History, from Aesop to Harry Potter* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2008), 7.

112. Lisa Guernsey, "Are Ebooks Any Good?," *School Library Journal*, June 7, 2011, <http://www.slj.com/2011/06/books-media/ebooks/are-ebooks-any-good/>.

113. Elizabeth Bird, "Planet App: Kids' Book Apps Are Everywhere. But Are They Any Good?," *School Library Journal*, January 1, 2011, <http://www.slj.com/2011/01/reviews/apps/planet-app-kids-book-apps-are-everywhere-but-are-they-any-good/>.

Copyright of Information & Culture is the property of University of Texas Press and its content may not be copied or emailed to multiple sites or posted to a listserv without the copyright holder's express written permission. However, users may print, download, or email articles for individual use.